# Better Auth: OAuth state accepted as a Magic Link and replayed as an OAuth Proxy profile

**Better Auth: OAuth state accepted as a Magic Link and replayed as an OAuth Proxy profile** - Author not stated, Better Auth project.


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## Content

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# better-auth: OAuth state can be used as a Magic Link to sign in as another user

- Advisory: GHSA-965c-763c-88jm
- CVE: CVE-2026-114607
- Severity: critical
- Published: 2026-10-27
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## Affected

- `better-auth` (npm): >= 1.4.0-beta.18, < 1.7.7, fixed in 1.7.7

## Description

## Am I affected?

You may be affected if you use `better-auth` from `1.4.0-beta.18` through versions before `1.7.7` with the Magic Link plugin and social or Generic OAuth sign-in.

You are affected if **all** of these are true:

- Magic Link is enabled with default `storeToken: "plain"`, or with `storeToken: "hashed"` and global `verification.storeIdentifier: "hashed"` (including a hashed default).
- At least one built-in social provider or Generic OAuth provider is enabled.
- OAuth state uses `account.storeStateStrategy: "database"`, the default when a database or secondary storage is configured.

Cookie-backed state blocks this path, subject to the OAuth Proxy condition below. With custom hashers, confirm the flows cannot resolve to the same stored identifier.

## Summary

Better Auth accepts an OAuth sign-in state value as a Magic Link token. An attacker can start an OAuth sign-in with any email address and use the returned state value to finish a Magic Link sign-in for that address. They never prove that they can read that email.

## Impact

An unauthenticated attacker who knows a user's email address can get a normal session for that user, with all of that account's permissions. They need no access to the mailbox, and they do not need to sign in with the OAuth provider or complete an OAuth callback.

If Magic Link sign-up is enabled and no user has the email address, the attacker can instead create an account that Better Auth wrongly marks as email verified, and is signed in to it. The false verified-email flag can also bypass Better Auth's default unproven-account protections when the mailbox owner later signs in, leaving the attacker's session in that account. Applications that trust verified email addresses or email domains may give this account more access, depending on the application.

## Patches

The fix is merged for the planned `better-auth` 1.7.7 release. That package is not available yet.

Upgrade `better-auth` and installed Better Auth adapters, plugins, and integrations released alongside it together. Upgrade servers sharing verification storage in the same cutover. Request new Magic Links and restart pending OAuth or SAML sign-ins; links and state created before the upgrade cannot complete. Update custom `verification.storeIdentifier.overrides` rules to match the `magic-link:` and `auth-state:` prefixes. There is no user or account data migration, and public token values and API signatures are unchanged.

## Workarounds

Until you upgrade to the fixed release, use one of these mitigations:

- Set `account.storeStateStrategy` to `"cookie"`. If you also use OAuth Proxy, first configure one dedicated OAuth Proxy `secret` across all participating environments that differs from each environment's global Better Auth secret. Cookie-backed state can expose a separate OAuth Proxy account-takeover path when the proxy shares the global secret and implicit account linking is enabled.
- Set the Magic Link plugin option `storeToken` to `"hashed"` **and** leave global `verification.storeIdentifier` unset or set it to `"plain"`. Global identifier hashing does not prevent this issue when Magic Link tokens are also hashed.
- Turn off Magic Link sign-in, or turn off social and Generic OAuth sign-in.

Setting `disableSignUp: true` on the Magic Link plugin is not enough. It only stops the creation of new verified accounts. It does not stop the takeover of existing accounts.

## References

- <https://github.com/better-auth/better-auth/security/advisories/GHSA-965c-763c-88jm>
- <https://nvd.nist.gov/vuln/detail/CVE-2026-114607>
- <https://github.com/better-auth/better-auth/pull/11494>
- <https://github.com/better-auth/better-auth/commit/ac54bfd67821a7607533af2059858b12bc54e26a>
- <https://github.com/better-auth/better-auth/releases/tag/v1.7.7>
- <https://github.com/advisories/GHSA-965c-763c-88jm>

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